(a) Cutting down the burden of salaries, pensions and the PFs (down-sizing/right-sizing of the government, out of every 3 vacancies 1 to be filled up, interest cut on the PF, pension reforms-PFRDA, etc.);

(b) Cutting down the subsidies (Administered Price Mechanism in petroleum, fertilisers, sugar, drugs to be rationalised, it was done with mixed successes);

(c) Interest burden to be cut down (by going for lesser and lesser borrowings, pre-payment of external debts, debt swaps, promoting external lending, minimal dependence on costlier external borrowings, etc.);

(d) Defence being one major item of the expenditure bilateral negotiations initiated with China and Pakistan (the historical and psychological enemies against whom the Indian defence preparedness was directed to, as supposed) so that the defence force cut could be completed on the borders, etc;

(e) Budgetary supports to the loss-making PSUs to be an exception than a rule;

(f) Expenditure reform started by the governments in different areas and departments;

(g) General Services to be motivated towards profit with subsidised services to the needy only (railways, power, water, etc.);

(h) Postal deficits to be checked by involving the post offices in other areas of profit;

(i) Higher education declared as non-priority sector; fees of institutions of professional courses revised upward; etc.

(ii) Increasing *revenue receipts*:

(a) Tax reforms initiated (Cenvat, VAT, Service Tax, GST proposed, etc.);

(b) The PSUs to be disinvested and even privatised (if a political concensus reached which alludes today);

(c) Surplus forex reserves to be used in external lending and purchasing foreign high quality sovereign bonds, etc.